

Parliament: Quick Revision Notes

UPSC Polity | Composition, Sessions, Officers and Legislative Procedure

Official syllabus anchor: GS Paper II - Parliament, State Legislatures; Prelims GS Paper I - Indian Polity and Governance: Constitution, Political System.

1. Master Map

Parliament of India | +-- President: formal constitutional component; assent to bills +-- Rajya Sabha: Council of States; Upper House; permanent +-- Lok Sabha: House of the People; Lower House; directly elected Core functions: Law-making + Financial control + Executive accountability + Democratic deliberation

2. Composition and House Comparison

Feature	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Nature	House of the People; directly elected	Council of States; indirectly elected
Representation	People of India	States and Union Territories
Tenure	Normal term: 5 years; can be dissolved earlier	Permanent House; not subject to dissolution
Retirement	Ends with dissolution/election cycle	One-third members retire every 2 years
Minimum age	25 years	30 years
Power position	Stronger in financial matters and executive accountability	Important for federal review and deliberation

3. Sessions: Four Key Terms

Term	Meaning	Authority	Applies to
Summoning	Calling the House to meet	President	Both Houses
Adjournment	Pausing or ending a sitting	Presiding Officer	Both Houses
Prorogation	Ending a session	President	Both Houses
Dissolution	Ending the Lok Sabha itself	President	Lok Sabha only

Recall line: Adjournment ends a sitting; prorogation ends a session; dissolution ends Lok Sabha.

4. Officers of Parliament

House	Main Presiding Officer	How chosen	Deputy Officer
Lok Sabha	Speaker	Elected by Lok Sabha members	Deputy Speaker
Rajya Sabha	Chairman	Vice-President of India ex-officio	Deputy Chairman

High-yield points: Speaker certifies Money Bills; Speaker presides over joint sitting; Speaker's neutrality protects fair debate, opposition rights, and executive accountability.

5. Ordinary Bill Flow

Ordinary Bill | +-- Introduced in either House +-- First Reading: introduction +-- Second Reading: general discussion, committee scrutiny, clause-by-clause consideration, amendments +-- Third Reading: final voting +-- Sent to second House +-- Passed by both Houses +-- President's assent +-- Act / Law

Exam point: Joint sitting may be used for ordinary bills in specified deadlock situations. It is not used for Money Bills or Constitutional Amendment Bills.

6. Money Bill: L-S-14 Formula

Element	Must Remember
Nature	Deals only with Article 110 matters: taxation, borrowing, Consolidated Fund, appropriation and related matters
Introduction	Only in Lok Sabha
Recommendation	President's prior recommendation required
Certification	Speaker of Lok Sabha certifies whether it is a Money Bill
Rajya Sabha role	Cannot reject or amend; can only recommend changes
Time limit	Must return within 14 days
If not returned	Deemed to have been passed by both Houses

Recall line: Money Bill = Lok Sabha only + Speaker certification + 14 days.

7. Budget Procedure

Term	Meaning
Annual Financial Statement	Constitutional name for the Budget
Demands for Grants	Ministry-wise expenditure demands; voted by Lok Sabha
Appropriation Bill	Authorises withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund of India
Finance Bill	Gives effect to taxation proposals

8. Parliamentary Control and Privileges

Area	High-Yield Notes
Executive control	Questions, debates, motions, committees and financial control keep the executive accountable.
No-confidence motion	If passed in Lok Sabha, the Council of Ministers must resign.
Collective responsibility	Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to Lok Sabha.
Privileges	Functional safeguards, not personal exemptions. They protect free speech, voting and internal functioning of Parliament.

9. Final One-Page Recall Sheet

Area	Answer in 2 seconds
Composition	President + Rajya Sabha + Lok Sabha
Rajya Sabha	Permanent; one-third retire every two years
Lok Sabha	Directly elected; 5-year normal term; dissolvable
Age	Lok Sabha 25; Rajya Sabha 30
Six-month rule	Gap between two sessions cannot exceed 6 months

Area	Answer in 2 seconds
Summoning / Prorogation	President
Adjournment	Presiding Officer
Dissolution	Lok Sabha only
Rajya Sabha Chairman	Vice-President of India
Ordinary Bill	Either House
Money Bill	Lok Sabha only; Speaker certifies; RS has 14 days
Privilege phrase	Functional safeguards, not personal exemptions

Final Memory Hook

C-S-O-B-C = Composition, Sessions, Officers, Bills, Control.